

Wear Detection. It is a kitted-out pair of TWS earphones, but it does miss out on multipoint connection which can let you connect to two devices simultaneously. That's a bummer because it's a highly useful feature.

PERFORMANCE

Equipped with 12.4 mm drivers and SBC and AAC codec support, the Realme Buds Air 5 have a warm, V-shaped sound signa-

warm quality of the lows combined with the sparkle of the treble creates a nice harmonious mix.

The drop-off in the highs is slightly harsh but it won't bother general consumers too much. There isn't as much sibilance in the highs as on the Realme Buds Air 3, so that's a step in the right direction. The imaging is also great with elements of tracks positioned accurately in the mix. The soundstage is quite narrow,

turned on is quite mediocre. The company promises 4.5 hours on the earbuds and 22 hours in total with ANC or Transparency Mode turned on.

In my testing, I got 4 hours of playback from the earbuds with ANC turned on and the battery at 50 per cent. The charging case provided 3 full charges and had some battery left to spare – but not enough for a fourth full charge. These numbers, while decent, are beaten by competitors such as the OnePlus Nord Buds 2. So, realme could have done better here. There is fast charging support here, which is a good thing, but no wireless charging. But that's forgiven at this price point.



Gangsta Granny's thoughts

"Yo, these Realme Buds Air 5 may not have all the bells and whistles, but they're packin' some serious bang for your buck with that bass-forward groove and street-smart features. Granny's got her groove on with these!"

ture out of the box. I wish the company had added aptX or LDAC codec support since that would have taken the sound quality to the next level, but oh well. As I mentioned before, you can customise the sound via the app, but I will share my thoughts on the default sound signature. The sound favours the bass frequency with some boosting in the 20 Hz - 500 Hz range. However, it is not excessively boosted, as we see in some earphones in the budget segment.

In comparison to the OnePlus Nord Buds 2, the Realme Buds Air 5 have a more balanced sound profile. The bass, while boosted, doesn't mask the clarity of the mids as much as the OnePlus Nord Buds 2 does. Instruments such as bass guitars and drums sound full-bodied and melodious. Male vocals also have good timbre and quality. The highs from 1.25 kHz to 5 kHz are boosted yet again to create a V-shaped sound signature. The

but that is expected on earbuds of this size. Overall, these are one of the better-sounding earphones under ₹4,000. The only TWS earbuds that sound better than the Realme Buds Air 5 in my opinion are the OPPO Enco Air3, but you do miss out on Active Noise Cancellation on those.

As for the microphones, the company has provided a six-microphone setup – three in each earbud – that does a fine job when used for taking calls. My voice sounded clear on calls over mobile networks or the internet, so no complaints there. Ambient sounds, however, are sometimes let through in noisy areas.

BATTERY LIFE

The Realme Buds Air 5 comes with a rated battery life of 7 hours on the earbuds and 38 hours in total with the earbuds and charging case. This is a pretty decent improvement compared to its predecessor, but I felt that the battery life with ANC

VERDICT

The Realme Buds Air 5 is an all-rounder in every sense of the word. My one complaint – battery life – is also not terrible; just not the best in the segment. The earphones are well-built and have a wonderful fit. The sound quality is tuned for the masses with a bass-forward approach, but realme hasn't gone overboard with it, so the sound still maintains the integrity of the mids and highs. Add to that the plethora of features Realme has provided, and you've got yourself a winner! Yes, there are no high-quality codecs and there's no multipoint connectivity, but these features are rarely seen at this price anyway.

The Realme Buds Air 5 is one of my top 3 recommendations for the best TWS earphones to get under ₹4K, and I think it will stay there for a while – or at least until realme comes out with the next iteration.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Driver size: 12.4 mm | Frequency response: 20 Hz - 20 kHz | Microphones: 3 per earbud | Impedance: 32Ω | Bluetooth codecs: AAC, SBC | Bluetooth version: 5.3 | Bluetooth range: 10 m / 33 feet | Weight: 4.4 g (earbud), 45.5 g (overall) | IP rating: IPX5 | Noise cancellation: Yes, up to 50 dB | Battery life (AAC, Normal mode): 7 hours (earbuds), 38 hours (earbuds + charging case) | Battery life (AAC, Noise Cancellation/Transparency Mode): 4.5 hours (earbuds), 22 hours (earbuds + charging case) | Colours: Deep Sea Blue, Arctic White

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